

Shuvam Das

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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy in Communication Arts **ongoing**
University of Wisconsin–Madison, USA

Master of Arts in Communication Arts **2025**
University of Wisconsin–Madison, USA
Research Area: Media and Cultural Studies

Master of Arts in Comparative Literature **2023**
Jadavpur University, Kolkata, India
Area Studies: Centre for Canadian Studies

Bachelor of Arts (with Honours) in Comparative Literature **2021**
Jadavpur University, Kolkata, India
Minors: English, Film Studies

APPOINTMENTS

Teaching Assistant **2024–present**
Communication Arts, University of Wisconsin–Madison

Grader **2026**
Communication Arts, University of Wisconsin–Madison

Project Assistant **2026**
Communication Arts, University of Wisconsin–Madison

Project Fellow **2023–2024**
School of Cultural Texts and Records, Jadavpur University

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed journal articles

Das, Shuvam. 2023. “Laughing bodies and the tickle machine: understanding the YouTube pipeline through alt-right humour.” *Journal for Cultural Research* 27 (4): 391–405.
doi:10.1080/14797585.2023.2253564.

Das, Shuvam. 2022. "The Symbol of Peace as a Myth: Deconstructing the Existential Problem in *One Punch Man* and *My Hero Academia*," *Essence and Critique: Journal of Literature and Drama Studies* 2: 42–53

PRESENTATIONS

Conference Presentations

- 29/10/2026 "From Discord Servers to the Singha Durbar: GenZ protests in South Asia as digital counter-conducts." Annual Conference on South Asia, Center for South Asia, University of Wisconsin–Madison.
- 29/09/2026 "From Text to Summary: polysemy and in AI-generated summaries." Creative Futures Lab, University of Wisconsin–Madison.
- 28/04/2026 "Video to Go: A Social History of the Portable DVD Player and the Mobile Family." Society for Cinema and Media Studies, Chicago.
- 27/06/2025 "Looking at/through the body: disrupted identification with the possessed woman in horror and its subversion in *Smile*." Consoleing Passions, Atlanta.
- 16/04/2025 "Let there be Luce: Reddit Posts on the Vatican's new mascot and the digital cult object." Popular Culture Association, New Orleans.
- 07/04/2024 "Children of Progress: *Amar Chitra Katha* comics in neoliberal India." Graduate Comics Organization, University of Florida.
- 13/04/2023 "The social construction of racial humour on YouTube." Modern Languages and Cultural Studies, University of Alberta.
- 16/02/2023 "Racialized bodies, oceans, and lands: Komagata Maru and Canadian immigration policy." Centre for Canadian Studies, Jadavpur University.

Other Talks

- 19/03/2026 "DVD on the Go: the Portable DVD Player as a Children's Media Device." Media and Cultural Studies Colloquium, University of Wisconsin–Madison.
- 09/10/2025 "Understanding the Vatican's mascot for the Jubilee as a sacred object." Media and Cultural Studies Colloquium, University of Wisconsin–Madison.

TEACHING AND GRADING

Teaching Assistant

- **Communication Arts 250 (Survey of Contemporary Media)** 2026–present
 - Media and cultural studies gateway course for Communication Arts majors.
 - Emphasis on media technologies, texts, industries, and audiences.

- Taught 4 discussion sections per week, on a 16-week semester schedule.
- Graded participation, essays, research papers, and exams.

Teaching Assistant/Primary Instructor

- **Communication Arts 100 (Intro to Speech Composition)** 2024–2026
 - Core course on college-level research, writing, and public speaking.
 - Taught 2 sections, 2/3 times per week on a 16-week semester schedule.
 - Created syllabi and Canvas course pages for each class section.
 - Graded outlines, manuscripts, and delivery; proctored and graded exams.

Grader

- **Communication Arts 323 (Business and Culture of Disney)** 2026
 - 4-week intensive summer course on a political economy approach to Disney.
 - Graded weekly journals, proposals, midterm review, and final assignment for 50 students, including research papers and recorded presentations.

AWARDS

1. **Weaver Excellence Award**, awarded to recognize outstanding efforts in research, teaching, and service, University of Wisconsin–Madison, April, 2026.
2. **Conference Travel Scholarships**, Department of Communication Arts, University of Wisconsin–Madison, McCarty Fund, 2025-2026.
3. **Baxter Research Award**, Department of Communication Arts, University of Wisconsin–Madison, The Marilyn R. Baxter Trust Gift, November 2025.
4. **Graduate School Fellowship**, Office of the Provost at the University of Wisconsin-Madison, Wisconsin Alumni Research Foundation: May-August, 2025.
5. **Victor J. Ramraj Memorial Award**, for the “best student paper in diasporic studies,” Centre for Canadian Studies, Jadavpur University, and the Shastri Indo-Canadian Institute, February 16, 2023.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

1. **Editorial board**, *Velvet Light Trap*, University of Texas Press, 2024-present.
2. **Ad hoc reviewer**, *Convergence*, Sage Journals, 1x article, 2026.
3. **Representative**, Graduate Student Organization, UW–Madison, 2026-present.
4. **Organising committee**, Midwest Graduate Film & Media Studies Symposium, 2026.
5. **Volunteer teacher**, Teach for India, Kolkata Municipal Corp. Public School, 2023.
6. **Submissions editor**, Debrupa Bal Memorial Students’ Seminar, JUCL, 2023.
7. **Oral history interviewer**, 1947 Partition Archive, Stanford University Libraries, 2022.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS AND SKILLS

1. **Academic associations**: Society for Cinema and Media Studies
2. **Pedagogical training**: Delta Research Mentor Community, Discussion Project
3. **Languages**: English, Bengali, Hindi/Urdu, Japanese
4. **Technical skills**: MS Office, Adobe Suite, HTML, CSS